```
    }
}
```

❶ Simple variable definition, no types needed (note quotes, though)

❷ Familiar ${} substitution syntax

Config file variables are often used for things like the application name or version numbers since repeating them in many places in the file could potentially be dangerous. It's also possible to use system properties or environment variables in the substitutions:

```
hostname=${?HOST_NAME}          ❶
MyAppl {
  version = 10
  description = "My application"
  database {
    connect="jdbc:mysql://${hostname}/mydata"
    user="me"
  }
}
```

❶ Question mark (?) means optional

The problem is that you never know for sure that these properties exist. To account for this, you can make use of the possibility that the redefinition of a property overrules the previous definition. And the substitution of a system property or environment variable definition vanishes if there's no value for the specified property HOST_NAME. Here's how to do this:

```
hostname="localhost"                ❶
hostname=${?HOST_NAME}              ❷
MyAppl {
  version = 10
  description = "My application"
  database {
    connect="jdbc:mysql://${hostname}/mydata"
    user="me"
  }
}
```